UCLA Extension

396253: Global Business Practices in Sustainability MGMT-X 481.5

Spring 2024 Section 1 4 Credits 04/01/2024 to 06/10/2024 Modified 04/07/2024

Meeting Times

Mondays, 4/1 – 6/3/2024

Time: 6:30PM - 9:30PM

Location: UCLA Extension Lindbrook Center, 204CD

Format: Hybrid (In-Person)

Schedule

01 Apr 2024 Lecture: UCLA Extension Lindbrook Center, 204CD

08 Apr 2024 Lecture: UCLA Extension Lindbrook Center, 204CD

15 Apr 2024 Lecture: UCLA Extension Lindbrook Center, 204CD

22 Apr 2024 Lecture: UCLA Extension Lindbrook Center, 204CD

29 Apr 2024 Lecture: UCLA Extension Lindbrook Center, 204CD

06 May 2024 Lecture: Remote Classroom

13 May 2024 Lecture: UCLA Extension Lindbrook Center, 204CD

20 May 2024 Lecture: UCLA Extension Lindbrook Center, 204CD

27 May 2024 Online

03 Jun 2024 Lecture: UCLA Extension Lindbrook Center, 204CD

10 Jun 2024 Lecture: UCLA Extension Lindbrook Center, 204CD

Description

This course provides a broad overview of global business practices in sustainability, designed to help students develop a strong foundation in this complex subject. The primary focus is helping students understand the business rationale for sustainability. Students examine why and how a business is addressing environmental and sustainability issues across sectors and industries. Additionally, the course covers the various principles, models, methodologies, and indicators of sustainability to help students understand how global business awareness and practices in the field have evolved since the concept first emerged in the 1980s.

Objectives

Students will come away with:

- An understanding of how organizations can strike a balance between business, social and environmental objectives while managing complex stakeholder relationships
- Strategies to gain competitive advantage through social and environmentally sustainable practices, including product and process innovation and ethical and sustainable supply chain management
- Deeper awareness of best practices across industries in the areas of social and environmentally sustainable business and leadership skills to enable action as an internal change agent
- The ability to think strategically and act entrepreneurially to create value through sustainable business practices

Outcomes

By the end of this course, students will be able to:

- Make the business case for sustainable business practices
- Cite examples of savings (financial, natural and human resources) across a variety of industries and sizes of organizations
- Evaluate and/or design and conduct a sustainability audit for an organization

Materials

Mandatory: Course Reader

Course Reader (Noeth, ISBN 9788891803542, Spring 2024) can be purchased through the UCLA Store, online or on campus: MGMT X481.5 - Global Business Practices in Sustainability Course Reader.

We will also use excerpts in class from the forthcoming book, *The ESG and Sustainability Deskbook for Business: A Guide to Policy, Regulation, and Practice*, written by Kristyn Noeth, to be published by Apress (2024).

Recommended Reading

The ESG and Sustainability Deskbook for Business: A Guide to Policy Regulation, and Practice, by Kristyn Noeth, published 2024, Apress

Higher Ground, by Alison Taylor, published 2024, Harvard Business Review Press

Corporate Sustainability: A Strategy? by George Serafeim, published 2019 (revised 2021), Harvard Business School Working Paper Series

How to Avoid a Climate Disaster, by Bill Gates, published 2021, Vintage Books

Cradle to Cradle: Remaking the Way We Make Things, by William McDonough & Michael Braungart, published 2002, North Point Press
UCLA Sustainability Plan, published 2022, UCLA

Deliverables

Report and News: Weekly Report and News: Materials and Case Study Analysis

Weekly Report and News: Materials and Case Study Analysis

Most weeks I will assign a business case study, or other materials found in your Course Reader. The student will be responsible for reading and analyzing the materials, and for writing a one-page (approximately 200-500 words) discussion report providing feedback, impressions, and analysis of the materials (see Assignments for specific details). I will provide questions to help guide the content of the student discussion report, which the student must post to Canvas by 12pm (midnight) Sunday before the next class week.

Students are encouraged to post one news story that pertains to that week's sustainability topic or business industry. A brief comment to one or more of the news stories that your classmates have posted will generate discussions and enhance peer-based learning (plus, you will get practice in objectively considering other viewpoints).

Mid-Term Project: Corporate Sustainability Reporting

Mid-Term Project: Corporate Sustainability Reporting

Students will review the Unilever "Annual Report and Accounts 2023," which is included in the Course Reader. Students will review and analyze various environmental, social, and governance aspects of the Unilever report. I will provide an outline for that review and analysis. This will enable the student to better understand the elements of corporate sustainability reporting in general and as it related to annual corporate reporting, and to sharpen their critical analysis skills. Students will work in groups for this project (to be assigned during class) and present their report in the classroom.

Final Project: Corporate Sustainability Audit

Final Project: Corporate Sustainability Audit

Students will conduct a corporate sustainability audit for a company that has not yet produced a public sustainability report. Students will prepare a written audit following the outline I share for the final project as well as present their audit report to the class. Students may choose to work individually or in groups of 2.

Students will identify a business that does not currently produce a sustainability report. This could be a local company or any business the student would be interested in studying and analyzing for the course.

The Final Project will allow the student to apply the corporate sustainability reporting best practices we will learn during the course and the learnings from the mid-term project in assessing how the selected business might undertake its first sustainability report. I will share an outline for the final project to guide students in this undertaking.

Students should conduct at least one interview with a decision-maker at the selected company during the course of work for the final project. We will discuss parameters for those interviews, and they are intended to further familiarize the student with the company sustainability practices in order to prepare informed recommendations for the corporate sustainability audit. Based on your research and interviews, you will prepare a written audit following the given outline and make a presentation to your classmates to share your audit analysis.

✔ Evaluation

The course will be conducted according to the highest professional and academic standards in order to optimize the learning experience of each student. To facilitate the learning process, the workload will be balanced and the student's enjoyment of the course will be considered. Each week will focus on analyzing and addressing a challenge involving a sustainability issue in business. Online discussion will follow, with a debate of viewpoints offered by the students.

Student engagement and participation will be integral to understanding the principles, policies, and practical applications of sustainability in business. Less value will be placed on the quantity of contributions than on quality of content. Participation means participating in online discussions and small group exercises, sharing relevant news items, and contributing to group projects. An important part of contributing to any endeavor is showing up prepared. NOTE: participation is 20% of your grade.

I understand that sometimes you are unable to turn your assignment in on time. On time participation is a critical element of peer learning in an online environment. If you are unable to complete assignments on time, please reach out to me to discuss. Plagiarism will not be tolerated. Students must form their own opinions and write their own papers. Up to 25% of clearly quoted and referenced material is acceptable. The Course Policies and Criteria provide additional information.

Criteria

Case write ups, essays

5 = excellent, thoughtful analysis and opinion
4 = good, shows understanding of case
3 = average, just summarizes facts presented in case
2 = fair, shows lack of understanding
1 = poor, doesn't show any effort

Type	Weight	Topic	Notes
Weekly Assignments	20%		
Mid-Term Project	25%		
Final Project	30%		
Participation	25%		

Breakdown

Your work will be graded on the following scale:

Please note that all grades are FINAL.

Breakdown:

UNEX Grading Scheme for X/XL 200-299; X 300-499 Courses: A+ through F, with +/-, no D

Name:	Range:	
A+	100 %	to 97.0%
A	< 97.0 %	to 93.0%
A-	< 93.0 %	to 90.0%
B+	< 90.0 %	to 87.0%
B	< 87.0 %	to 83.0%
B-	< 83.0 %	to 80.0%
C+	< 80.0 %	to 77.0%
C	< 77.0 %	to 73.0%

Name:	Range:	
F	< 73.0 %	to 0.0%

Current grading scheme for this assignment

Course Policies

Course Policies and Format

Course Policies

- **Attendance is Required:** Students are encouraged to attend all classes as the learning environment is key to success in the course. Students are allowed one class absence. If you are unable to attend a class, please contact the instructor by sending a direct message via Canvas.
- **Late Work and Grading:** Students are encouraged to complete assignments when due. If you are unable to complete an assignment on time, please contact the instructor by sending a direct message via Canvas. Repeatedly turn in late assignments will result in grade reduction.
- **Regular Participation is Expected:** Students are encouraged to actively participate in class and in all course modules.

Course Format

This course is primarily conducted through in-person course sessions, using Canvas (the learning management system at UCLA Extension) to access materials provided by the instructor. Course materials delivered through Canvas may include:

- Course announcements and communications
- Readings, links, videos, and other media
- Assignment submission areas and grades

Please note that no hard copies of course materials will be made available in class; please print any reference materials necessary in advance of your course session. It is your responsibility to be aware of all assignments, due dates and guidelines.

Note the following points about online course components at UCLA Extension:

- Students must have basic computer skills, including the use of word processing software, email, and the ability to use internet browsers such as Firefox, Safari, or Chrome in order to complete activities and assignments in Canvas.
- Students should familiarize themselves with Canvas and are responsible for meeting the minimum technical requirements for using Canvas.
  - For more information about the Canvas learning management system, please visit: Our Platform—Overview (http://student.uclaextension.edu/our-platform/overview/)

- For information about the technical requirements for web-enhanced courses, please visit: Technical Requirements (http://student.uclaextension.edu/support/technical-requirements/)

Planning Your Study Time

To plan your study time, it is estimated that you will spend 3 hours per week "in class" with the instructor and approximately 7 additional hours per week outside of class studying for exams, reading, and completing assignments. Depending on the extent of your academic preparation and recent college-level coursework in this topic area, the amount of study time needed may vary considerably.

Institutional Policies

Student Conduct

Students are subject to disciplinary action for several types of misconduct or attempted misconduct, including but not limited to academic dishonesty, such as cheating, multiple submission, plagiarism, or knowingly furnishing false information to the University; or behavioral misconduct, such as theft or misuse of the intellectual property of others, harassment, or disruption of the learning environment.

All published and unpublished material, whether in manuscript, printed or electronic form, is covered under this definition and includes the use of material generated wholly or in part through the use of artificial intelligence (except when the use of AI has received prior authorization for assessment as a reasonable accommodation for a student's disability, or when the use of AI is a specified part of the coursework, e.g. data science or user experience). Students are encouraged to familiarize themselves with the Student Rights & Responsibilities Policy (https://www.uclaextension.edu/student-services/rights-and-responsibilities) and to report concerns.

Services for Students with Disabilities

In accordance with the Americans with Disabilities Act of 1990, UCLA Extension provides appropriate accommodations and support services to qualified applicants and students with disabilities. These include, but are not limited to, auxiliary aids/services such as sign language interpreters, assistive listening devices for hearing-impaired individuals, extended time for and proctoring of exams, and registration assistance. Accommodations and types of support services vary and are specifically designed to meet the disability-related needs of each student based on current, verifiable medical documentation. Arrangements for auxiliary aids/services are available only through UCLA Extension's Service for Students with Disabilities Office at (310) 825-7851 or by email at ODS@uclaextension.edu. For complete information, please visit Accessibility and Disability Services (https://www.uclaextension.edu/enrollment-and-support/accessibility-and-disability-services).

Incompletes

The interim grade Incomplete (I) may be approved for a student who has completed the majority of the course requirements, with passing quality (grade C or higher), but is unable to complete a small portion of the coursework by the course end date for good cause. For courses in which an Incomplete may be

allowed, approval by the instructor of record and the academic program director is required. The Incomplete grade is not an option for courses that do not bear credit, such as 700, 800, or 900-level courses.

- It is the student's responsibility to petition for an Incomplete by emailing the appropriate academic program department (https://www.uclaextension.edu/contact-ucla-extension) at least one week before the end of the course. The Program Department will initiate the petition process once the email is received.
- The student, the instructor, the CE/Program Director, and the program staff must complete the petition prior to the final course meeting or before the quarter end date (https://www.uclaextension.edu/calendar). This process can take up to one week to complete.
- The instructor will approve or deny the request. The instructor will provide details on what the student needs to accomplish in order to complete the course, as well as a due date for submitting completed work. The due date cannot exceed the end of the ensuing quarter (https://www.uclaextension.edu/calendar) when a final grade must be reported or the Incomplete lapses to the grade "F," "NP," or "U." Visit UCLA Extension Grading Scale (https://www.uclaextension.edu/transcripts-credits-grades/grading-scale) for more information.

An Incomplete allows the student to complete only work that is outstanding and does not allow prior completed work to be retaken or resubmitted.

All Grades are Final

No change of grade may be made by anyone other than the instructor, and then, only to correct clerical errors. No term grade except Incomplete may be revised by re-examination. The correction of a clerical error may be authorized only by the instructor of record communicating directly with personnel of Student and Alumni Services.

Sexual Harassment

The University of California is committed to creating and maintaining a community where all individuals who participate in University programs and activities can work and learn together in an atmosphere free of harassment, exploitation, or intimidation. Every member of the community should be aware that the University prohibits sexual harassment and sexual violence, and that such behavior violates both law and University policy. The University will respond promptly and effectively to reports of sexual harassment and sexual violence, and will take appropriate action to prevent, to correct, and when necessary, to discipline behavior that violates our policy.

All Extension students and instructors who believe they have been sexually harassed are encouraged to contact the Department of Student and Alumni Services for complaint resolution: UCLA Extension, 1145 Gayley Ave., Los Angeles, CA 90024; Voice/TTY: (310) 825-7031. For more information, please view the University's full Policy on Sexual Harassment and Sexual Violence (https://policy.ucop.edu/doc/4000385/SVSH).

Additional Items

Protecting Privacy and Data During Live Instruction

Live meeting sessions for this class, when applicable, are being conducted over Zoom. As the host, the instructor may be recording live sessions. Only the host has the ability to record meetings, no recording by other means is permitted. Recorded sessions will be posted in the Videos area of this class unless otherwise notified. Due to privacy, recordings are not available for download and are only accessible via Canvas for the duration of the class. If you have privacy concerns and do not wish to appear in the recording, do not turn on your video and/or audio. If you also prefer to use a pseudonym instead of your name, please let the instructor know what name you will be using so that the instructor knows who you are during the session. To rename yourself during a Zoom meeting, click on Participants, click on your name, click on More, click on Rename. If you would like to ask a question, you may do so privately through the Zoom chat by addressing your chat question to the instructor only (and not to ""everyone""). Additionally, chat may be used and moderated for live questions, and saving of chats is enabled. If you have questions or concerns about this, please contact the instructor via Canvas Inbox.

Pursuant to the terms of the agreement between Zoom and UCLA Extension, the data is used solely for this purpose and Zoom is prohibited from re-disclosing this information. UCLA Extension also does not use the data for any other purpose. Recordings will be deleted when no longer necessary. However, recordings may become part of an administrative disciplinary record if misconduct occurs during a video conference.

Course and Instructor Evaluation

UCLA Extension values your feedback on course and instructor evaluations. We ask all students to take a few minutes to complete an end-of-course evaluation survey. Updates to the course and instruction are influenced by your feedback. Understanding your student experience is essential to ensure continuing excellence in the online classroom and is appreciated by your instructor and the UCLA Extension academic leadership.

Your participation in a survey is voluntary, and your responses are confidential. After instructors submit grades, they will be given an evaluation report, but this report will not contain your name.

About Your Online Course Materials

Please note the following about online course components at UCLA Extension:

- Students must have basic computer skills, including the use of word processing software, email, and the ability to use internet browsers, such as Safari, Firefox, or Chrome.
- Students are responsible for meeting the technical requirements of Canvas and familiarizing themselves with the Canvas Learning Management System.
  - What are the browser and computer requirements for Canvas? (https://community.canvaslms.com/t5/Canvas-Basics-Guide/What-are-the-browser-and-computer-requirements-for-Instructure/ta-p/66)
- Students are responsible for keeping a copy of all assignments and work submitted, and to be aware of all assignments, due dates, and course guidelines.
- Students have access to courses via Canvas for an additional 30 calendar days after the course end date listed in the syllabus (the first 14 days are full access; the rest are read-only).

- Students are encouraged to download/print content throughout the duration of the course and before the additional 30-day access ends. No further access is possible after the course becomes unavailable.

  To download all your assignment submissions in Canvas, please refer to the online support guide. (https://community.canvaslms.com/docs/DOC-10606) for more information or contact Canvas Support via the help menu within Canvas.

UCLA Extension Canvas and Learning Support

For immediate 24/7 Canvas technical support, including holidays, click on **Help** (located on the menu to the left) where you can call or chat live with a Canvas Support representative.

UCLA Extension Academic Technology and Learning Innovation
The UCLA Extension Learning Support staff assists both students and instructors with Canvas-related technical support, as well as general and administrative questions.

Learning Support staff is available Monday through Friday, from 8 AM to 9 PM (Pacific Time), except holidays:

- Email: atli@uclaextension.edu (mailto:atli@uclaextension.edu)

Campus Safety Escorts

For students taking classes held on the UCLA campus and in and around Westwood Village, the UCLA Police Department provides a free walking escort service every day of the year from dusk until 1 a.m. Community Service Officers (CSOs) are available to walk students, faculty, staff members and visitors to and from anywhere on campus, in Westwood Village, and in the village apartments. CSOs are uniformed students who have received special training and are employed by the UCLA Police Department. To obtain an escort, please call (310) 794-9255 and allow 15 to 20 minutes for your escort to arrive. For complete information, see UCLA Evening Escorts (https://police.ucla.edu/cso/evening-escorts).

Schedule

When	Module Title	Notes

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Week 1 (April 1, 2024) Classroom	Introductions & Sustainability in Global Business Overview	Lesson Topics: • Introductions • Goals for the course • Syllabus review • Tools and resources • Sustainability in Global Business overview, including origins, trends, and differentiation of sustainability, corporate social responsibility (CSR), and environmental, social, and governance (ESG) Activities: • Ice breaker introductions • Open discussion of goals for the course • Sustainability in Global Business Presentation • Course Reading: Business Roundtable, *Statement on the Purpose of a Corporation*
Week 2 (April 8, 2024) Classroom	Foundations in Global Sustainability	Lesson Topics: • Key International Policies, Treaties, and Conventions • U.N. Sustainable Development Goals • World Economic Forum Risk Reports • IPCC Findings and Climate Policy Activities: • Foundations in Global Sustainability Presentation • Open discussion on progress in global business • Course Reading: United Nations, *The Sustainable Development Goals Report 2023*

When	Module Title	Notes
Week 3 (April 15, 2024) Classroom	Exploring and Integrating Environmental, Social, and Governance Factors and Metrics	Lesson Topics: • A Deep Dive on the “E” Factors and Metrics • A Deep Dive on the “S” Factors and Metrics • A Deep Dive on the “G” Factors and Metrics • Integration of ESG into Business Strategy • Sustainability and Profitability • Role of the Financial Sector and Investor Expectations Activities: • Exploring and Intergrating ESG into Business Strategy Presentation • Open discussion on how global businesses approach and measures performance on E, S, and G factors • Course reading: BlackRock, *Stakeholder capitalism: the sustainability of corporate value*
Week 4 (April 22, 2024) Classroom	Global Sustainability Regulations, Standards, and Ratings Frameworks	Lesson Topics: • The Global Regulatory Paradigm • Progression of International Standards • Discussion of ESG Ratings • Implication for Risk Management Activities: • Global Sustainability Regulations, Standards, and Ratings Frameworks Presentation • Open discuss on global business response to and integration of new requirements, and the compliance and risk aspects of navigating a changing landscape • Course reading: Larry Fink, *The Power of Capitalism;* McKinsey, *Putting stakeholder capitalism into practice*
Week 5 (April 29, 2024) Classroom	Mid-Term Project Presentations	Lesson Topics & Activities: • Student Presentations of Mid-Term Projects (Unilever Report) • Class Participation and Engagement with Fellow Students • Class Discussion of Key Aspects of Unilever Report • Class Discussion re: Final Projects

When	Module Title	Notes
Week 6 (May 6, 2024) Remote (Zoom)	Business Sustainability Roundtable	Lesson Topics: • Guest Speakers Building with Purpose and Leading Corporate Sustainability • Practical Insights from Sustainability Leaders • Discussion of Global Emerging Sustainability Trends • Sharing Tips on Navigating a Career Path in Sustainability Activities: • Class Discussion with Guest Speakers • Course reading: NYU Stern Center for Sustainable Business, *Natura Case Study: Measuring the Financial Return on Sustainability Investment*
Week 7 (May 13, 2024) Classroom	Corporate Purpose, the Aligned Corporation, and Stakeholder Engagement	Lesson Topics: • Aligning Purpose and Strategy • Alternate Corporate Stuctures and B Corps • Board of Directors Oversight • Sustainability Program Development and Reporting • Stakeholder Engagement • Continuous Innovation, Green Jobs, & Reskilling Activities: • Corporate Purpose, the Aligned Corporation, and Stakeholder Engagement Presentation • Open discussion on the role of the corporation, business alignment with purpose, and stakeholder engagement strategies • Course reading: NYU Stern Center for Sustainable Business, *The Business Case for Sustainable Apparel at EILEEN FISHER;* NYU Stern Center for Sustainable Business, *The Business Case for Sustainable Farming to Improve Biodiversity*
Week 8 (May 20, 2024) Classroom	Role of International Bodies, Non-governmental Organizations (NGOs), Business Interest Groups, and the Philanthropic Sector	Lesson Topics: • Driving International Agreement and Multilateralism • Overview of the Key Convening Organizations • Worldwide Business Engagement with Organizations Activities: • Role of International Bodies, Non-governmental Organizations (NGOs), Business Interest Groups, and the Philanthropic Sector Presentation • Open discussion on the role and function of the international organizations, and how companies interact and partner with those organizations to achieve impact across the globe • Course reading: Patagonia, *Annual Benefit Corporation Report*

When	Module Title	Notes
Week 9 (May 27, 2024) Online	Pathways to Decarbonizing Key Business Sectors	Lesson Topics: • Pathways to Decarbonizing Key Business Sectors Activities (Online Reading and Participation): • Students will review the Pathways to Decarbonizing Key Business Sectors Presentation provided online • Students will review the online course materials and participate in the online activities for this week • Course reading: Online course materials
Week 10 (June 3, 2024) Classroom	Career Transitions in Sustainability and Making Impact (and Answering Any Remaining Final Project Questions)	Lesson Topics: • Careers in Sustainability • Keeping Pace with Emerging Trends • How to Achieve Impact Activities: • Career Transitions in Sustainability and Making Impact Presentation • Open discussion on how to adapt a career for longevity in the sustainability field; open Q&A on any remaining questions as students prepare their sustainability audits (final projects)
Week 11 (June 10, 2024) Classroom	Final Project Presentations & Course Wrap-Up	Lesson Topics & Activities: • Student Presentations of Final Projects • Class Participation and Engagement with Fellow Students • Course Wrap-Up and Celebration